

Appendix 3. Visual Examples of NSS Motif

Figure 1: The Recurring Motif of Parallel Hand Placement in NSS Across the WENN



Note:

Figure 1A. A reproduction of the Venus figurine from Malta (Mal'ta–Buret' culture, Siberia, Russia; c. 23,000 BP), displayed at the National Museum in Prague. Carved predominantly from mammoth ivory, over 30 such figurines have been recovered from the site. Notably, all specimens with preserved arms exhibit a consistent sculptural convention: both hands are placed parallel to each other across the lower abdomen, centred at the navel. Photograph by Zde, licensed under CC BY-SA 4.0.

Figure 1B. T-shaped Pillar 18 in Enclosure D at Göbekli Tepe, Turkey, displaying the characteristic parallel hand placement of the NSS motif. Byun Dae-Jung photographed this at the Şanlıurfa Museum on 17 June 2017.

Figure 1C. Bird-headed statue from Göbekli Tepe, Turkey, also exhibiting the parallel hand placement typical of the NSS motif. Photographed by Byun Dae-Jung at the Şanlıurfa Museum on 17 June 2017.

Figure 1D. The Urfa Man (c. 9000 BCE) from Göbekli Tepe, Turkey, showing the defining parallel hand placement of the NCS motif. Byun Dae-Jung captured this image at the Şanlıurfa Museum on 17 June 2017.

Figure 1E. A Badarian female mortuary figurine from Egypt (c. 5000–4000 BCE), featuring the characteristic hand position. This image, sourced from the Louvre Museum, is by Rama et al., licensed under CC BY-SA 3.0.

Figure 1F. The Ain Ghazal statue from the Late Pre-Pottery Neolithic B period (6700–6500 BCE), housed in the Jordan Archaeological Museum, Amman. This image is by Michael Gunther, CC BY-SA 4.0.

Figure 1G. A Greek NSS figurine (c. 6500–3300 BCE) exhibited in the Archaeological Museum of Athens. Byun Dae-Jung photographed this on 28 April 2022.

Figure 1H. A Vinča clay figurine from the Late Neolithic (4500–4000 BCE), displayed at the British Museum. Image by Michel Wal, licensed under CC BY-SA 3.0.

Figure 1I. "La Dame de Saint-Sernin" statue-menhir (c. 3100–2900 BCE), housed in the Musée Fenaille, Rodez. Image by Sailko, licensed under CC BY 3.0.

Figure 1J. A stone-carved female figurine from the Hongshan Culture (c. 6660–5000 years ago), excavated in Chifeng, Inner Mongolia. Byun Dae-Jung photographed this on 1 December 2019 at the Chifeng Museum.

Figure 1K. An NSS artefact from the Chifeng region, Inner Mongolia (c. 6200–5200 BCE). Byun Dae-Jung photographed this on 24 November 2019 at the Liaoning Provincial Museum.

Figure 1L. The Daejeonggol *Dol Hareubang*, a traditional basalt statue from Jeju Island (Korean Peninsula). Although its origin and precise date remain unknown, it exhibits the characteristic parallel hand placement. Photographed by Byun Dae-Jung on 11 June 2013 at Jeju Island.